*ACTIVITY 4*

# Conduct an Interview and Triangulate Evidence

ISO 9001 Quality Management System (QMS) Internal Auditor Training
TGS-2023039341 · K2 · A2 · LO2 · 75 minutes

## Objective

Collect reliable audit evidence through professional questioning, observation, record review and corroboration.

## Scenario

A production operator states that updated drawings are always available at the workstation. The document controller states that obsolete copies are removed within one day. The scenario evidence includes a revision register, workstation photograph description and two production records.

## Materials

- Auditor, operator, document-controller and observer role cards
- Sample revision register and production-record extracts
- Evidence-log workbook and interview-observation checklist

## Activity questions

- Which opening questions establish the process before testing a specific control?
- Which answers require follow-up evidence, and what would corroborate them?
- What is factual evidence, what is hearsay and what is an auditor inference?
- Is the evidence sufficient for a finding, or is more sampling needed?

## Required evidence

- Interview plan
- Evidence notes
- Triangulation table
- Observer feedback
- Provisional conclusion

## Detailed Procedure

**1.** Assign the four roles and read only the role card for your assigned role.

**2.** The auditor prepares a short interview sequence: purpose, process walk-through, risk-based follow-up and evidence request.

**3.** Open the interview by confirming purpose, time and confidentiality. Use neutral language and establish rapport.

**4.** Ask open questions, then probe with clarify, compare, show-me and what-happens-if prompts.

**5.** Record exact identifiers, dates and observations. Separate quoted information from the auditor's interpretation.

**6.** Request and review the supplied records. Compare revision identifiers across the register, workstation and production record.

**7.** Triangulate the interview, record and observation evidence. Identify agreements, contradictions and gaps.

**8.** State a provisional conclusion and the limitation of the sample. Decide whether an additional sample is needed.

**9.** The observer gives feedback on neutrality, listening, sequencing, evidence capture and time control; rotate roles if time permits.

## Acceptance Check

The conclusion cites verifiable evidence from at least two sources, separates fact from inference and states any sampling limitation.

## Learner completion checklist

| Done | Evidence / output | Reviewer comment |
|---|---|---|
| ■ | Interview plan | |
| ■ | Evidence notes | |
| ■ | Triangulation table | |
| ■ | Observer feedback | |
| ■ | Provisional conclusion | |